

Games and pastimes

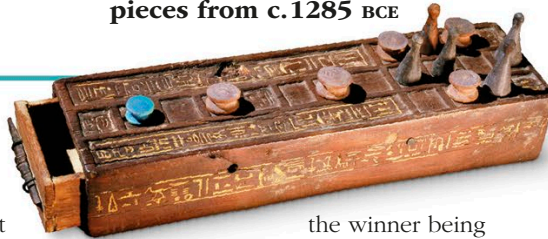
Indoor games and pastimes have been discovered dating back thousands of years, and many are still enjoyed today. Often, these games are played just for fun, but some are also educational, teaching skills such as math, logical thinking, and how to plan ahead. Many of the games shown here are played worldwide.

Ancient board games

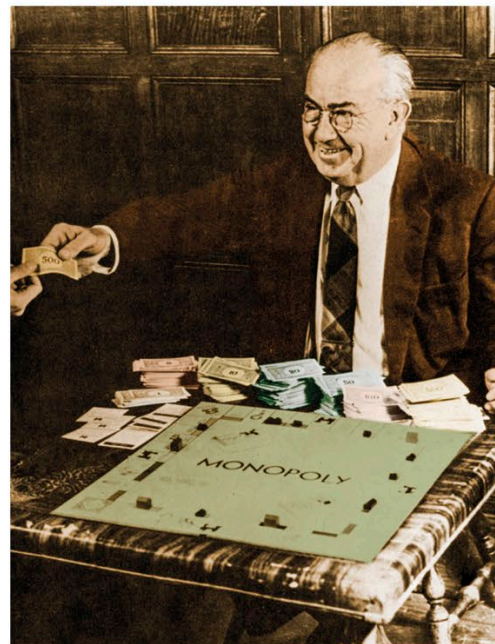
- **What?** Senet
- **Who?** Ancient Egyptians
- **Where and when?** Egypt, c. 3100 BCE

The earliest known board game, Senet was played on a small board marked with 30 squares, set out in three rows of 10 squares each. Players took turns moving small pieces around the squares,

Senet board and pieces from c.1285 BCE



the winner being the first to clear all their pieces off the board. The game was supposed to represent the journey of a person's spirit to the afterlife.



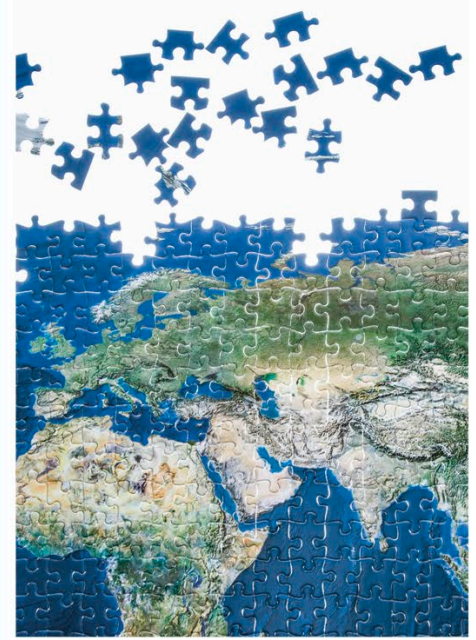
Modern board games

- **What?** Monopoly
- **Who?** Elizabeth Magie, Charles Darrow
- **Where and when?** US, 1904 and 1935

One of the most popular board games of all time, Monopoly was originally called the "Landlord Game." It was created by the American games designer Elizabeth Magie, who wanted it to act as a warning against property ownership and greedy landlords. It only became popular when another designer, Charles Darrow, turned it into Monopoly, a board game celebrating property ownership.

Charles Darrow was the first millionaire games designer

Modern jigsaw of a world map



Picture puzzles

- **What?** Jigsaws
- **Who?** John Spilsbury
- **Where and when?** UK, 1766

It is believed that the first jigsaw puzzle was made by the British map maker John Spilsbury in 1766 as an educational tool. He stuck a map of Europe onto a piece of wood, which he then cut into pieces with a jigsaw, so students could learn geography by reassembling the pieces. The term "jigsaw" comes from the type of saw used to create the puzzles.

WOW!

The largest jigsaw puzzle ever made had 551,232 pieces that formed a picture of a giant lotus flower.